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REUTERS

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If there's anyone in Formula One who understands the art of maintaining incredible streaks, it's reigning world champion Max Verstappen. From having the most wins and points in a row to winning four consecutive drivers' titles, he is an expert in the subject. However, 2025 brought a change in fortune. Heading into Imola, the seventh race of the season, Verstappen had only one win under his belt — a stark contrast to previous years, where he had already claimed four victories by this point.

But write off Verstappen at your own peril. At the iconic Autodromo Internazionale Enzo e Dino Ferrari — better known as Imola — the Red Bull driver sent a powerful message.

With a bold overtake at Turn 1, Verstappen surged into the lead and never looked back. His victory at the Emilia-Romagna Grand Prix marked his fourth consecutive win at the circuit, adding yet another record to his already glittering resume.

Earlier, McLaren looked poised for another strong weekend after dominating all practice sessions. And sure enough, it was Oscar Piastri who once again outpaced teammate Lando Norris to snatch his third career pole position.

Verstappen had to settle for second on the grid, missing out on a hat-trick of poles. Yet, starting behind Piastri offered an opportunity for payback — after all, the pole-sitter had denied him wins in the two recent races.

With a mixed starting grid for the main race, and tyre strategies and degradation management being the talk of the town, the stage was set, and a silent comeback was in the reckoning.

Starting from second on the grid allowed Verstappen a potentially cleaner overtake in the first braking zone — the Tamburello *chicane* —

MAX MUSCLES THROUGH AT IMOLA

The Dutchman's victory at the Emilia-Romagna Grand Prix marked his **fourth consecutive win** at the circuit, adding yet another record to his already glittering resume.